

Glovo is trying to build a community on top of a service customers don't trust.

Their 2024-2025 redesign added social features—friend connections, video discovery, curated restaurant lists—but their Trustpilot rating is 2.2 stars. 56% of reviewers say they won't use Glovo again. That's not a foundation for community. That's a fundamental problem.

Company Snapshot

What Glovo Is: Spanish delivery platform operating in 23 countries across Europe, Western Asia, and Africa. Founded 2014 in Barcelona. Now owned by Germany's Delivery Hero.

4.3M

ACTIVE CUSTOMERS

120K

MONTHLY COURIERS

150K

LOCAL STORES

80M+

TOTAL DOWNLOADS

The Strategic Shift: October 2024: Launched "Glovo Next" redesign with social features (connect with friends, share restaurant picks, vertical video feed). June 2025: Added AI gifting assistant, personalized homepage, flash deals.

They're trying to evolve from logistics tool to social commerce platform. From "I need food" to "I want to see what my community is eating."

Key Findings

1

They operate on two incompatible tracks

Marketing talks about community, care, sustainability. Product optimizes for speed, convenience, transaction volume. Result: Brand feels incoherent.

2

Social features exist but don't create community

Friend connections, shared picks, video discovery—all launched. But if customers fundamentally distrust your service, they won't build social graphs in your app.

3

Courier experience undermines the narrative

Corporate site: "Let's do it together," partnership language. Rider app reality: Algorithmic control, no delivery choice. Your physical brand ambassadors feel like cogs in a machine.

4

Visual identity is strong but messaging is confused

Helio design system: Professional, consistent, distinctive yellow. But what are they? Fast delivery tool? Social discovery platform? Everything app? Answer changes depending on which page you're on.

Strategic Gap Analysis

Glovo positions itself as community-focused, sustainable, and caring. Their actual product experience is high-speed logistics with customer service problems.

Gap 1: "Community" Language, Transactional Experience

"Glovo is the first in the industry to combine social media elements within our platform... a new and interactive way for users to discover, share, and engage."

— Chief Product Officer, October 2024

What Users Get: An app optimized for fastest possible checkout. Real-time tracking focused on delivery ETA, not on the human bringing your food. Interface designed to ignore the courier and restaurant owner—just watch the timer.

You can add all the social features you want. If the core experience treats delivery as pure logistics, you're not building community. You're adding noise.

Gap 2: Partner Language vs. Algorithmic Control

What They Say: Recruitment pages use "Let's do it together." They frame the courier relationship as a "journey to grow and digitise your business." Corporate site promises "fair standards, upskilling, social rights."

What Couriers Experience: "If a rider has two orders picked up you can not choose what to deliver first." The algorithm decides. You're the execution layer.

You can't claim partnership while removing agency. If couriers feel like algorithmic tools, the "community partner" story falls apart.

Gap 3: Sustainability Claims vs. Consumption Mechanics

What They Say: 8,854 tons CO2 reduced. 1,124 tons food waste avoided. 6M sustainable packaging units. Sustainability "in our DNA."

What The Product Does: Optimizes for high-frequency ordering. Primary messaging: "Order anything you want," "delivery in minutes." Every design choice encourages more transactions.

You can't build an app that makes overconsumption frictionless, then claim sustainability is in your DNA. That's not a growth model, it's greenwashing.

Gap 4: Innovation Theater vs. Operational Reality

What They Launch: Social features, AI gifting, flash deals, personalized profiles.

What Customers Report: 2.2 stars. "Customer service unpleasant." "Order never arrived, no refund." "They closed my case 3 times." 56% won't use again.

Product team ships features. Operations team can't deliver basics. You can't build loyalty on a broken service by adding a video feed.

Social Media Audit

The Social Features: What They Built

October 2024 Launch ("Glovo Next"): Friend connections within app, "Picks" (curated restaurant/dish lists), Video Discovery Wall (vertical videos of menu items), User profiles (name, photo, favorites).

Strategic Intent: Move from "users open app when hungry" to "users browse app for social discovery." Increase time-in-app. Reduce customer acquisition cost. Build psychological lock-in.

The Question: Does Anyone Use This?

I can't access internal usage data. But I can look at what Glovo's doing on actual social media platforms.

INSTAGRAM/FACEBOOK

Standard brand account. Product shots, promos, campaign announcements. Nothing wrong with it. Nothing special either. Comments are mostly logistics questions ("Why isn't my order here?") not engagement.

WHAT'S MISSING

No evidence of community. The social features launched October 2024 don't seem to have created visible conversation outside the app.

The Social Features vs. Social Media Reality

Glovo's betting I'll: (1) Connect my friends inside the Glovo app (2) Curate and share restaurant lists within Glovo (3) Browse a Glovo-specific video feed instead of TikTok (4) Treat delivery logistics as a social activity.

That's a big ask. Especially when your core service has a 2.2-star rating.

Video Discovery Wall: The Real Bet

The vertical video feed is Glovo's attempt to solve the "Utility Trap"—users only opening the app when they need something.

The Reality Check: I can already watch food videos on TikTok and Instagram. Those platforms have better recommendation algorithms, actual communities, creators I already follow, entertainment value beyond "here's what you can order."

The Missing Piece: Courier Content

If Glovo wants to be a community platform, the couriers should be the stars. 120,000 monthly couriers. Each one navigating cities, interacting with restaurants, experiencing local culture. That's content gold.

But Glovo doesn't spotlight couriers as creators. They're logistics nodes. **That's the missed opportunity.** You have 120K people on the ground. If you treated them as community members instead of delivery mechanisms, you'd have authentic content.

Verdict

The social features exist. They're well-designed. But existence isn't adoption. I don't see evidence that Glovo's social features created a community. I see a delivery app that added social mechanics to increase engagement metrics. **There's a difference.**

Customer Experience Breakdown

2.2



Trustpilot Rating

1,278+ reviews | 27% would recommend

56% say they won't use Glovo again

For context: Industry average for delivery apps is 3.5-4.0 stars. Glovo is a full star to two stars below baseline.

What Customers Actually Say

PATTERN 1: UNDELIVERED ORDERS, NO REFUNDS

"The delivery person never showed up. Glovo said I was not at home. That was not true... After a month now I received no refund."

— Verified reviewer, Oct 2025

PATTERN 2: CUSTOMER SERVICE THAT DOESN'T SERVE

"1 in 4 orders are not delivered. Customer service is each time more unpleasant, they only attend after more than one hour delay."

— Verified reviewer, 2025

"Several items were missing from 2 orders... I contacted Glovo help and they closed the case 3 times! without refunding."

— Verified reviewer, December 2025

Brand Promise Violations

- **Promise:** "We save you time, when you don't have it." **Reality:** Customers spend an hour+ waiting for support responses.
- **Promise:** "With Glovo, you have the city in the palm of your hands." **Reality:** An app that sometimes delivers and sometimes doesn't, with no clear recourse.
- **Promise:** "Glovo is the number one app!" **Reality:** You can order. Whether you get it is another question.

Why This Matters for the Brand

You can't build "community" on a foundation of broken promises.

Social features are supposed to create lock-in. The theory: Users might switch apps for a discount (utility decision), but won't leave if their friend network lives in your app (community lock-in).

But if 56% of users say they won't come back, you don't have a retention problem you can solve with features. You have a service problem you're avoiding.

2.2 stars isn't an outlier or bad luck. It's a pattern. The service doesn't match the promise. And you can't fix that with social features.

Visual Identity & Messaging Consistency

What Glovo Gets Right: The Helio Design System

Glovo's visual identity is actually good. Professional, distinctive, consistent.



The logo evolved from "Globo" (balloon) to this minimalist wordmark. Clean, recognizable, with the distinctive yellow pin marker.

COLOR PALETTE



Yellow + green combination is unique in delivery space. Not brutalist tech, not soft lifestyle. "Vibrant functional."

TECHNICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Design system built on YAML files storing primitive colors and spacing. Shared component library. This allows consistency across thousands of screens in 23 countries.

This is professional work. The visual identity isn't the problem.

What Glovo Gets Wrong: Messaging Coherence

The design system is consistent. The message is not.

ON HOMEPAGE

"Glovo is the number one app for ordering anything you want!"

Direct, utility-focused. Market dominance claim.

ON ABOUT PAGE

"Enhancing the lives of people in their cities."

Softer, community-focused. Purpose-driven.

ON SUSTAINABILITY PAGE

"Social Impact," "eco-friendly growth model," "in our DNA."

Impact narrative. Environmental credentials.

ON CAREERS PAGE

"Gas" (speed), "Good Vibes" (trust), "Stay Humble."

Internal culture that never reaches customers.

These aren't variations of the same voice. They're three different brands sharing a visual system.

The "Community" Language Audit

"Community of foodies" (Glovo Next), "Local community" (Sustainability), "Our community" (Careers). None of these are actual communities. They're stakeholder categories.

A community has: shared identity beyond the transaction, member-to-member interaction, cultural norms and inside knowledge, reasons to exist beyond the product.

Glovo's "community" is marketing language, not sociology.

The Fix

Glovo needs a messaging system as rigorous as Helio. Define: Core brand voice, Primary message, Supporting messages, Off-brand examples. Then enforce it the way Helio enforces color codes.

Until then, you have a great-looking brand saying twelve different things.

Recommendations

The Core Problem: Glovo is building features to solve problems they refuse to acknowledge. Poor customer service? Add social features. Low trust? Add video discovery. None of this works. You can't feature your way out of operational failure.

1

Fix Service Quality Before Adding Features

Pause new feature development. Redirect resources to operations.

SPECIFIC ACTIONS

- Hire 2x customer service capacity to cut response time from 60+ minutes to under 15
- Automate refund processing (shouldn't take a month)
- Improve driver communication tools
- Create "service quality score" visible to customers

2

Pick a Lane—Utility or Community

Stop trying to be both a logistics tool and a social platform. Choose one, commit to it, align everything to support it.

OPTIONS

- **Option A:** Double down on Utility—"Fastest, most reliable delivery"
- **Option B:** Commit to Community—"Your city's food community" (requires fixing service first)
- **Option C:** Everything App (current)—Confused messaging, feature bloat. This doesn't work.

3

Make Impact Metrics Visible in the Product

If sustainability is a real value, show it where customers actually are: in the transaction flow.

IMPLEMENTATION

- Real-time tracking: Show "CO2 saved by choosing bike delivery"
- Checkout: Display "food waste prevented" as cumulative stat
- Profile: Personal impact dashboard

4

Create a Messaging System as Rigorous as Helio

Build a brand voice framework with the same discipline as your design system.

DEFINE

- Primary brand voice (pick one—not all four)
- Message hierarchy (core claim, supporting messages)
- Off-brand examples ("never say this")
- Copy approval process like design QA

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE (12 MONTHS)

- Trustpilot: 3.5+ stars (from 2.2)
- Retention: 70%+ would use again (from 44%)
- Support response: Under 15 minutes (from 60+)
- Brand perception: Clear answer to "What is Glovo for?"

This audit isn't about tearing down Glovo. It's about seeing what others miss. Most people look at social features and think "innovation." I see a company avoiding its operational

problems. The gap between what a brand says and what it does—that's where the story is.

And for Glovo, that gap is wide.